

Bobicheng Zhang

PHD STUDENT · PSYCHOLOGY · COGNITIVE NEUROSCIENCE

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Education

Michigan State University

PHD PSYCHOLOGY

- Advisor: Dr. Jan Brascamp

East Lansing, MI

Jul 2020 - present

University of Chicago

MA SOCIAL SCIENCES

- Advisor: Dr. Steve Shevell

Chicago, IL

Oct 2018 - Jun 2019

University of Denver

BS PSYCHOLOGY

- Minors in Mathematics and Sociology
- Independent Study Advisor: Dr. Timothy Sweeny

Denver, CO

Sep 2014 - Jun 2018

Research

Michigan State University - Dept of Psychology

PHD ADVISOR

- Dissertation: "Pupillary responses to perceptual decision making during perceptual bistability"
- Use eyetracker to track eye movements such as optokinetic nystagmus and record pupil size.
- Write an algorithm in Python that allows for inference of perceptual interpretations during bistability without explicit report.
- Use statistical methods such as cluster mass to avoid multiple comparisons during significance testing.

East Lansing, MI

2020-Present

University of Chicago - Institute for Mind and Biology

MA ADVISOR

- Thesis: "Binocularly driven competing neural responses and the perceptual resolution of color"
- Reviewed literature, conducted experiment and submitted an highly rated MA thesis in less than 7 months.
- Performed statistical analyses such as non-orthogonal contrast to demonstrate that binocular neurons in V1 resolve neural ambiguity during chromatic interocular-switch rivalry.

Chicago, IL

2018-2020

University of Denver - Dept of Psychology

SUPERVISOR

- Independent Study: "The effect of chromatic adaptation on affective perceptual decision making"
- Reviewed literature in efforts to understand relationships between colors and emotion perception.
- Learned to program psychophysics experiments in Matlab to present morphed emotional faces that were backward-masked.

Denver, CO

2016-2018

Publications

PUBLISHED

Zhang, B., Marshev, V., & Brascamp, J. W. (2025). The pupil response to perceptual switches: What happens when you ignore them. *Journal of Vision*, 25(8), 5-5.

Smith, O.M., Jeffery, B.E., Leuenberger, W., Mack, K.M, Pizzo, G, **Zhang, B** & Davis, C. Widespread lack of article accessibility policies among ecology and evolution journals. *Nat Ecol Evol* (2025). <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41559-025-02694-8>

- Zhang, B.** & Brascamp, J.W. (2022). Modest effect of knowledge on bistable perception of structure-from-motion. *Vision Research*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.visres.2022.108118>
- Zhang, B.**, Slezak, E., Wang, W. & Shevell, S.K.(2021). Binocularly-driven competing neural responses and the perceptual resolution of color. *Journal of Vision*, 21(10), 15-15.

UNDER REVIEW

Brascamp, J.W., **Zhang, B.** & Marshev, V. Fixational saccade inhibition and pupil dilation during limb movement preparation. *PLOS One*

IN PREP

Weilbach, D.T. & **Zhang, B.** Small Business Resilience Index: Longitudinal evaluation of Colorado Small Business.

Presentations

** presenting author; + presented by lead author*

- +Brascamp, J. W., **Zhang, B.**, & Marshev, V. (July 2025). Rate of fixational saccades reveals intention to move limbs. Poster Presentation, Gordon Research Conference, South Hadley, MA
- +Cottone, M., Padula, I., Gampala, G. & Brascamp, J. W. (April 2025). Investigating the Impact of Stimulus Movement on Pupil Size Independent of Luminance. Poster Presentation, The Undergraduate Research and Arts Forum, East Lansing, MI
- +Brascamp, J. W., **Zhang, B.**, Frey, H & Marshev, V. (November 2024). Habituation of the pupil response to visual events. Poster Presentation, The Psychonomic Society Annual Meeting, New York City, NY
- ***Zhang, B.**, Brascamp, J. W., (May 2024). Perceptual switches during structure-from-motion do not elicit pupil dilation. Poster Presentation, Vision Sciences Society, St. Pete's Beach, FL
- ***Zhang, B.**, Brascamp, J. W., (November 2023). Inferring perceptual switches during structure-from-motion without report. Poster Presentation, The Psychonomic Society Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA
- ***Zhang, B.**, Brascamp, J. W., (August 2023). Separating event-related pupillary responses during perceptual bistability. Poster Presentation, Systems Vision Science Symposium, Tübingen, Germany
- ***Zhang, B.**, Brascamp, J. W., (November 2022). Modest effect of knowledge on bistable perception of structure-from-motion. Poster Presentation, Society for Neuroscience, San Diego, CA
- ***Zhang, B.**, Brascamp, J. W., (February 2022). Modest effect of knowledge on bistable perception of structure-from-motion. Oral Presentation, Michigan State University Graduate Academic Conference, East Lansing, MI
- ***Zhang, B.**, Shevell, S. K., (June 2019). Binocularly-driven neural responses to chromatic interocular-switch rivalry. Oral Presentation, University of Chicago Graduate Conference, Chicago, IL

Teaching Experience

Fall 2024	Introductory Psychology , Teaching Assistant
Spring 2024	Sensation & Perception Cognitive Psychology , Teaching Assistant
Spring 2023	Sensation & Perception Cognitive Psychology , Teaching Assistant
Fall 2022	Introductory Psychology , Teaching Assistant
Summer 2022	Data Analysis in Psychological Research , Instructor-of-Record
Spring 2022	Research Design and Measurements in Psychological Research , Teaching Assistant
Fall 2020	Cognitive Neuroscience , Teaching Assistant

Professional Experience _____

2021-Present **Research Volunteer**, Energize Colorado
2020-Present **Graduate Research Assistant**, Michigan State University
2018-2020 **Technical Assistant**, University of Chicago
2017-2018 **Intern Behavioral Technician**, Firefly Autism
2016-2018 **Undergraduate Research Assistant**, University of Denver
2015-2016 **Undergraduate Research Assistant**, Fostering Healthy Futures

Awards & Honors _____

May 2025	Graduate Educator Advancement and Teaching Fellowship , Michigan State University	\$ 5,000
Apr 2025	The Dean’s Fellowship , Michigan State University The Graduate School	\$ 2,250
Mar 2025	Educator of the Month , Michigan State University The Graduate School	
Sep 2023	Conference Award , MSU Council of Graduate Students	\$ 300
Mar 2023	Research Enhancement Award , MSU College of Social Sciences	\$ 660
Jun 2018	MAPSS Scholarship , University of Chicago Division of Social Sciences	\$ 24,000
Nov 2017	Public Pathways Scholar , U of Denver Dept of Psychology	
May 2017	Academic Achievement and Citizenship Award , U of Denver Dept of Psychology	
May 2017	Academic Achievement Award , U of Denver Dept of Psychology	

Outreach & Professional Development _____

SERVICE AND OUTREACH

2025 **Neurodiversity Fair**, Planning Committee Member
2025 **University Health and Well-being Summit**, Student Panelist
2024-Present **Disability Summit**, Planning Committee Member
2023-Present **Graduate Academic Conference**, Judge
2022-2024 **Psychology Scholars Undergraduate Program Workshop**, Graduate Student Panelist
2022-2024 **Council of Graduate Students**, Student Representative for Psychology
2022-2024 **University Committee on Graduate Studies**, Graduate Student Representative

DEVELOPMENT

Aug 2023 **Systems Vision Science Summer School & Symposium**, Max Planck Institute for Biological Cybernetics *Tübingen, Germany*
Jun 2022 **Certificate for College Teaching Workshop**, Michigan State University *East Lansing, MI*